THE

Body

GUIDE

VERSION 1.0 · NOVEMBER 2026

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SWISS ARMY MUM

Body Guide · Version 1.0 · November 2026

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NOT MEDICAL ADVICE

This guide is for education only. It does not diagnose, treat or replace a consultation with your doctor or another qualified health professional. Talk to your doctor before you change how you eat, train or supplement, especially if you have a health condition, take medication, or are pregnant. Take your self-assessment results and lab numbers to your appointments: you bring the data, they bring the clinical context.

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SCAN OR CLICK

PRINTING

Made for A4, printed double-sided. Each area opens on a right-hand page.

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A NOTE FROM DR. MICA

Why this guide exists

You have probably read the books. Saved the posts. Bought the magnesium. And still stood in the kitchen at 7 a.m. wondering which of it actually counts.

So have I. I spent ten years in catalysis research before I turned my PhD in chemical engineering on my own health. I wore the glucose monitor, tracked the sleep, ran the strength programmes. Most of what I read was noise. A small part did nearly all the work.

This guide is that small part, for your body. The few levers that matter most for sleep, food, movement and your brain, and how to pull them. One page each. Read it in a minute, keep it in your head, and use it to weigh up the next supplement or gadget that promises the world.

You don't need to do all of it. You need to know what counts.

Dr. Mica

FOUR PILLARS

Body
Keeps the machine running. Sleep, Fuel, Exercise, Brain.
YOU ARE HERE

Mind
Keeps you steady. Purpose, inner world, resilience, connection.

Glow
Skin, hair and hormones.

Flow
Systems, routines and getting your time back.

WHERE THIS GUIDE SITS

The best-selling Swiss Army knife isn't the one with 87 functions. It's the small one with seven tools that fits on a keyring. SAM works the same way. Four pillars, each with its own guide. This is the Body guide. The posts on Substack go deep. **This guide keeps what you need to act on.**

WHAT'S INSIDE

6 one-page briefs

2 self-checks

2 tools to act

1 place for notes and results

HOW TO USE THE BODY GUIDE

Start here

Three ways to use it. Pick whichever fits your day.

BUILT FOR SCREEN, PHONE AND PAPER

On your computer

Every teal button and link is live. Click it and the tool opens in your browser.

On your phone

Open the PDF and tap. Every tool works on a small screen, so you can do the checks on the sofa.

In print

Print the pages you want. Point your phone camera at a QR code and the tool opens straight away.

MAKE IT YOURS

The two online checks each come with a results page, and every area ends with a notes page. Type on them in your PDF app, or print them and use a pen. Date each entry, so you can compare when you come back.

VERSION 1.0

This guide grows. New tools come out in a post first, then land here, and the version number goes up. Paid subscribers get every new version. If you bought the guide once, you keep the version you bought.

HOW TO USE THE BODY GUIDE

Your route

1

Read the Body brief first

It is the map. It shows how the four areas fit and which one pays back most for the least effort. One page. Read it before anything else.

2

Pick one area. Only one.

Sleep, then Fuel, then Exercise, then Brain. Sleep goes first because everything else runs on it. Finish one area before you open the next.

3

Brief, then check, then tool

The brief gives you the why. The self-assessment shows where you stand. The tool turns it into a plan for this week.

4

Come back in 4 to 6 weeks

Retake the self-assessment. Compare it with your first round. Then move to the next area.

QUICK FINDER · CLICK A ROW TO JUMP THERE

I want to see the whole picture	Body brief →
I want to fix my sleep	Sleep brief, then the sleep check →
I want to understand my blood sugar and labs	Fuel brief, then the biomarkers brief →
I want to get stronger	Exercise brief, then the weekly planner →
I want to protect my brain	Brain brief →

SWISS ARMY MUM

Not every tool. Just the right ones.

BODY · PILLAR

Body: One System, Four Areas

Science-backed. Built for real life.

> *"Wind extinguishes a candle and energizes fire."*
>
> Nassim Nicholas Taleb, Antifragile. Small, regular stresses, like lifting something heavy or a little hunger, make the body stronger.

WHY IT MATTERS

Normal isn't the goal

A clean check-up only says nothing is broken yet. Healthy ageing is a long plateau close to your best, and its slope is set while every result still looks normal.

One transition, four areas

Falling oestrogen touches sleep, blood sugar, muscle and brain in the same decade. Night waking, cravings, fading muscle and lost words can share one root.

The areas feed each other

A short night shows up at breakfast as a craving. Steady blood sugar gives you energy to train. Training helps you sleep. Pull one lever and the loop turns.

Small dose, big return

About 150 minutes of moderate activity a week captures most of the drop in early-death risk. That's 1.5% of your week. A handful of levers, not a second job.

ONE SYSTEM, FOUR AREAS

- **Sleep: the foundation**
  Sets the ceiling for everything above it. Overnight, hunger, insulin and repair get reset.
- **Fuel: the signal system**
  Every meal sends instructions to your cells. Steady blood sugar keeps energy and cravings in check.
- **Exercise: the structure**
  Muscle soaks up blood sugar, protects joints and tells bone to stay dense. It fades after 30 unless loaded.
- **Brain: where it pays out**
  Most of its strongest evidence sits in the three areas above.

SELF-CHECK

Answer yes or no.

Q1 Do you wake at the same time every day, weekends included?

Q2 Do you get from meal to meal without a crash or a craving?

Q3 Do you lift something heavy at least twice a week?

Q4 Do you know your blood pressure and blood sugar this year?

Your first no, in this order, is where you start.

THE 80/20: ONE LEVER PER AREA, FOUR TO SIX WEEKS EACH

01
Sleep: one wake-up time

Same time seven days a week, weekends included. Bedtime tends to follow within a couple of weeks.

Regularity predicted mortality better than hours slept.

02
Fuel: protein and plants first

Build every meal from whole foods. Put protein and vegetables on the plate before anything else.

Eat the ingredients, not the ingredient list.

03
Exercise: lift heavy, walk daily

Two strength sessions a week on a base of 7,000 to 8,000 steps a day. Heavy means six reps feel hard.

Strength plus cardio beat cardio alone for women's hearts.

04
Brain: know your numbers

Check blood pressure and blood sugar yearly, and book a hearing test. All three are silent dementia risks.

Plus one recurring plan with people you enjoy.

THREE MISTAKES TO STOP MAKING

× **Starting with gadgets**
Glucose monitors, brain apps and supplement stacks feel like progress because they're new. They measure. Levers move.

× **All four areas at once**
January's sixteen half-habits are gone by February. Pick one area, hold its lever for a few weeks, then open the next.

× **Waiting for a bad result**
A clean check-up isn't permission to coast. The slope is set while everything still looks normal, when levers are cheapest.

This is educational, not personal medical advice. Your biology, history, and context matter. Work with a qualified healthcare professional.



01

Sleep

Start here. Everything else runs on it.

YOUR ROUTE THROUGH SLEEP

1 BRIEF
Sleep: the non-negotiable foundation

2 SELF-ASSESSMENT
The sleep check, plus your results page

3 NOTES
My notes: Sleep

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Not every tool. Just the right ones.

BODY · SLEEP

Sleep: The Non-Negotiable Foundation

Science-backed. Built for real life.

> *The shorter your sleep, the shorter your life.*
> Matthew Walker, neuroscientist & author, Why We Sleep

WHY IT MATTERS

Brain clears waste

Your glymphatic system flushes metabolic debris during sleep, including beta-amyloid proteins linked to Alzheimer's. Miss sleep, that garbage accumulates.

Hormones recalibrate

Sleep regulates insulin, cortisol, and your hunger hormones. Chronic restriction makes you insulin-resistant, raises cortisol, and drives sugar cravings.

Memory consolidates

NREM sleep runs a nightly file-transfer: hippocampus to cortex. Lose sleep, lose what you learned. You cannot recover it later.

Emotions destabilise

REM sleep regulates the amygdala, your threat-detection centre. Poor sleep amplifies emotional reactivity by up to 60%. You don't just feel tired; you feel worse about everything.

HOW SLEEP WORKS: TWO FACTORS

Circadian rhythm

Your 24h internal clock, driven by light. Melatonin rises at dusk to signal sleep. Screens and bright light delay it, pushing your sleep window later whether you want that or not.

Sleep pressure (adenosine)

A chemical building up every waking hour: it peaks after 12-16h to force sleep. Caffeine doesn't give you energy: it blocks adenosine receptors, masking fatigue until it crashes back all at once.

SELF-CHECK: ARE YOU ACTUALLY RESTING?

Answer honestly. Yes to any one of these is a signal.

Q1 Could you fall back asleep at 10 or 11 AM after waking?

Q2 Do you need caffeine to function before noon?

Q3 Do you rely on an alarm clock to wake at the right time?

Q4 Do you reread sentences or forget simple details during the day?

Yes to any = start with the four levers below.

THE 80/20: FOUR LEVERS THAT MOVE THE NEEDLE

01
Consistent schedule

Same bedtime and wake time every day. Even weekends. Even after a late night out.

Walker's single most effective intervention.

02
Morning sunlight

30 min of natural light within 2 hours of waking. Resets your circadian clock for the whole day.

Dark in winter? A 10,000 lux light box, 20 min.

03
Cool, dark bedroom

15-19°C (60-67°F). No screens. No noise. Core temperature must drop to initiate and sustain sleep.

18°C / 65°F is optimal for most adults.

04
Caffeine cutoff: 1 PM

Half-life is 5-7h. Your 3 PM espresso is still blocking adenosine at 9 PM when you need to wind down.

One change. Two weeks minimum. Then assess.

THREE MISTAKES TO STOP MAKING

× Alcohol as a sleep aid

It sedates you but destroys REM sleep. You're unconscious, not resting, and you'll wake emotionally flat and cognitively sluggish.

× Catching up on weekends

You can't bank sleep. Sleeping in on Saturday weakens your circadian rhythm and causes Sunday night insomnia. The debt doesn't clear.

× Lying in bed awake

After 20 minutes, get up. Do something boring until sleepy. Lying there anxious trains your brain to associate bed with stress.

This is educational, not personal medical advice. Your biology, history, and context matter. Work with a qualified healthcare professional.

SLEEP · SELF-ASSESSMENT

The sleep check

Hours alone are the wrong measure. **This check scores your sleep on six dimensions** and shows you the weakest one. That is your starting point, not everything at once.

Open the sleep check →

On screen: Click the button.

On paper: Scan the code with your phone camera.

Or type it: tools.swissarmymum.com/sleep

MY RESULTS

Round 1 today, then again every 4 to 6 weeks. Same time of day, same honesty.

DIMENSION	ROUND 1 *Date: _____*	ROUND 2 *Date: _____*	ROUND 3 *Date: _____*	ROUND 4 *Date: _____*
Regularity				
Satisfaction				
Alertness				
Timing				
Efficiency				
Duration				
My weakest dimension				
The one thing I will change				

SLEEP · MY NOTES

My notes: Sleep

Your page. Type on it in any PDF app, or print it and use a pen. Date every entry: in six weeks you will want to know what changed.

What I noticed this week	What I am trying	When I check again

DATE _____



02

Fuel

Steady blood sugar, steady energy. Know your numbers, then move them.

YOUR ROUTE THROUGH FUEL

1 BRIEF
Fuel: the master lever for metabolic health

2 SELF-ASSESSMENT
The metabolic health check

3 BRIEF
Metabolic biomarkers: which tests to ask for

4 TRACKER
Metabolic markers tracker

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BODY · FUEL

Fuel: The Master Lever for Metabolic Health

Science-backed. Built for real life.

> *When people could eat as much as they liked, an ultra-processed diet led them to eat about 500 more calories a day than an unprocessed one matched for sugar, fat and fibre.*
>
> Hall et al., Cell Metabolism, 2019 (NIH inpatient trial)

WHY IT MATTERS

Energy & Focus

Glucose spikes trigger insulin overshoots, crashing blood sugar and dragging down energy, mood, and concentration. Stable blood sugar means steady fuel to the brain all day.

Ageing & Glycation

Excess glucose permanently binds to proteins, forming advanced glycation end-products that stiffen vessels, damage the brain, and accelerate visible ageing in skin.

Insulin Resistance

Years of chronic spikes force the pancreas to overproduce insulin. Cells stop responding. The diagnosis comes late; the biology starts a decade earlier.

Gut & Immunity

Ultra-processed foods starve beneficial gut bacteria and strengthen harmful ones, driving inflammation, weakening the gut barrier, and impairing immune regulation.

HOW IT WORKS: TWO FACTORS

Insulin: The Storage Key

Think of insulin as the key that unlocks your cells. When blood sugar rises, insulin opens the door so glucose can enter. Repeated spikes keep the key turning constantly until the lock wears out: insulin resistance. More insulin is needed for the same effect, driving fat storage and inflammation.

Mitochondrial Overload

Flood the mitochondria (your cellular power stations) with more fuel than they can burn and they produce toxic free radicals instead of clean energy. This oxidative stress damages DNA, accelerates ageing, and feeds chronic inflammation in a self-reinforcing loop.

SELF-CHECK: HOW'S YOUR METABOLISM?

Answer honestly. Yes to any one of these is a signal.

Q1 Do you crash or crave sugar 2-3 hours after eating?

Q2 Do you rely on afternoon caffeine to function?

Q3 Do you feel brain fog or irritability before meals?

Q4 Do you struggle to lose weight despite "eating healthy"?

Yes to 2 or more? Start with the levers below.

THE 80/20: FOUR LEVERS THAT MOVE THE NEEDLE

01 Whole Foods, Not Products

Prioritise whole, unprocessed foods. Cut back on ultra-processed products, added sugars and refined grains. A simple rule: eat the ingredient, not a food with a list of ingredients.

Seed oils? The evidence is mixed. Cutting ultra-processed food is the clearer win.

02 Protein + Fat At Every Meal

Aim for 1.2-2.2 g protein per kg bodyweight. Add olive oil, avocado, nuts, oily fish. Protein and fat together slow glucose absorption, increase satiety, and preserve muscle, your best metabolic insurance.

Muscle is a glucose sink: it absorbs sugar without insulin. More muscle, better metabolic health.

03 Fibre First, 25-50g Daily

Start every meal with vegetables. Fibre forms a physical mesh in your gut that slows glucose absorption from everything eaten after it. Same plate, same calories: dramatically different glucose curve.

Fibre also feeds beneficial gut bacteria, which produce butyrate to further improve insulin sensitivity.

04 Close the Kitchen at 7 PM

Finish eating 2-3 hours before bed. Create a natural 12-14 hour overnight fast. Insulin sensitivity drops in the evening as melatonin rises, so eating late compounds every spike you had that day.

The "kitchen closed" rule removes nightly willpower battles. Make the decision once, not every evening.

THREE MISTAKES TO STOP MAKING

× Drinking Your Sugar

Juice, smoothies, lattes, and energy drinks are the fastest route to insulin resistance. Liquid fructose bypasses satiety completely and goes straight to the liver, where it converts to fat. Drink water, tea, or coffee.

× Eating Late at Night

The same meal eaten at 9 PM creates a larger glucose spike and lower insulin sensitivity than at 7 PM. Circadian biology is real. A late dinner is not a harmless treat: it compounds metabolic dysfunction daily.

× Aggressive Fasting

Prolonged fasting windows can disrupt menstrual cycles, raise cortisol, and paradoxically worsen insulin sensitivity in some women. A natural 12-14 hour overnight fast is all you need. More is not automatically better.

This is educational, not personal medical advice. Your biology, history, and context matter. Work with a qualified healthcare professional.

FUEL · SELF-ASSESSMENT

The metabolic health check

Insulin resistance builds quietly, years before a lab flags it. **This check reads the everyday signals** and tells you where you stand before you pay for a single test.

Open the metabolic check →

On screen: Click the button.

On paper: Scan the code with your phone camera.

Or type it: tools.swissarmymum.com/metabolic

MY RESULTS *Round 1 today, then again every 4 to 6 weeks.*

	ROUND 1 *Date: _____*	ROUND 2 *Date: _____*	ROUND 3 *Date: _____*	ROUND 4 *Date: _____*
My result				
What stood out				
What I will change first				
Questions for my doctor				
Next blood test due				

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Not every tool. Just the right ones.

BODY

Metabolic Health Biomarkers

Science-backed. Built for real life.

> *In a study of over 46,000 people, fasting glucose of 95–99 mg/dL carried meaningfully higher diabetes risk than under 85, despite both readings counting as "normal".*
>
> Nichols et al., American Journal of Medicine, 2008

WHY IT MATTERS

The lagging indicator

Fasting glucose only moves once your body has been compensating for years. By the time it reads abnormal, insulin resistance is already old news, not new news.

The early warning

Insulin climbs quietly long before glucose does, often a decade before anyone says "prediabetes." It's the smoke, not the fire alarm.

The skipped tests

Fasting insulin, HOMA-IR, and hsCRP catch dysfunction earliest, and most standard physicals don't order any of them.

Trends beat snapshots

One test is noisy: hydration, sleep, stress, even your cycle move the numbers. What matters is the direction over years, not one draw.

THE COMPLETE BIOMARKER PANEL

TIER 1 · ESSENTIAL

Test annually, this is your baseline.

Fasting Glucose

Blood sugar after an overnight fast. A lagging signal, but higher-normal readings still predict future risk.

Low-risk 70–85 mg/dL (3.9–4.7 mmol/L)

HbA1c

Your 3-month blood sugar average, more stable than a single glucose reading.

Low-risk 5.0–5.4%

Triglycerides

Excess glucose is converted into triglycerides and shipped out into the bloodstream to be stored in a process called *de novo lipogenesis*.

Optimal <80 mg/dL (0.9 mmol/L)

HDL Cholesterol

The "good" cholesterol that clears cholesterol from your blood.

Desirable >50 (W) · >40 (M) mg/dL (1.29 · 1.04 mmol/L)

Triglyceride:HDL Ratio

A quick insulin-resistance proxy when fasting insulin isn't available.

Low-risk <1.5, lower is better

Blood Pressure

High blood pressure is the most common preventable risk factor for cardiovascular diseases.

Optimal <120/80 mmHg

Waist Circumference

A proxy for visceral fat, the metabolically active fat that drives inflammation and insulin resistance.

Low-risk <80 (W) · <94 (M) cm

TIER 2 · ADVANCED

Ask for these by name if accessible.

Fasting Insulin

How much insulin your pancreas pumps after a fast. The earliest sign of resistance, years before glucose moves.

Low-risk 2–5 mIU/L

HOMA-IR

A calculation combining glucose and insulin into one score for how hard your pancreas is working.

Optimal <2.0, lower is better

hsCRP

An inflammation marker made by the liver. Chronic low-grade inflammation drives dysfunction and "inflammaging."

Low-risk <1.0 mg/L, lower is better

Uric Acid

A byproduct of fructose and purine breakdown, linked to metabolic stress and gout.

Low-risk 2–4 (W) · <5 (M) mg/dL

Liver Enzymes (AST/ALT/GGT)

Proteins released when liver cells are stressed, an early signal of fatty liver before disease appears. GGT is a unique marker in that it is one of the few tests that can offer a hint of oxidative stress

Low-risk ALT/AST <17 U/L
Low-risk GGT 14–20 (W) · <25 (M) U/L

THREE MISTAKES TO STOP MAKING

× **Panicking over one result**

A single reading can shift with hydration, sleep, stress, or your cycle. One out-of-range value is data, not a diagnosis.

× **Only testing what's ordered**

Standard panels check glucose and cholesterol, not the markers that catch dysfunction earliest. Ask for fasting insulin and hsCRP by name.

× **Chasing "normal," not low-risk**

Clinical ranges flag disease, not optimal function. Aim for the low-risk zone, which sits inside "normal" but is a tighter, better target.

This is educational, not personal medical advice. Your biology, history, and context matter. Work with a qualified healthcare professional.

FUEL · TRACKER

Metabolic markers tracker

One lab result is a photo. Five years of them is a film. **Type in your values and the sheet does the rest:** it calculates HOMA-IR and your triglyceride to HDL ratio, then colours each marker green, yellow or red.

Get your copy of the tracker →

On screen: Click the button.

On paper: Scan the code with your phone camera.

Your copy: Google Sheets, yours to keep.

The link makes your own private copy of the sheet. You need a free Google account.

HOW IT WORKS

1
Make your copy
Click the button or scan the code. The sheet saves to your own Google Drive.

2
Add each lab result
Type in the date and your values every time you get new bloods done.

3
Read the colours
Each marker turns green, yellow or red. HOMA-IR and the ratio are worked out for you.

WHAT THE SHEET TRACKS

Fasting glucose
Blood sugar after an overnight fast.

HbA1c
Average blood sugar over about three months.

Fasting insulin
How hard your body works to keep glucose down.

HOMA-IR
Insulin resistance, from glucose and insulin. Calculated.

Triglycerides
Blood fats that rise with sugar, refined carbs and alcohol.

HDL cholesterol
The protective cholesterol. Low is the warning sign.

Triglyceride : HDL
A second view of insulin resistance. Calculated.

Blood pressure
The strain on your arteries, top and bottom number.

Waist
A tape-measure proxy for belly (visceral) fat.

hsCRP
Low-grade inflammation in the body.

Uric acid
Rises with fructose, alcohol and insulin resistance.

ALT / AST / GGT
Liver enzymes. An early signal of fatty liver.

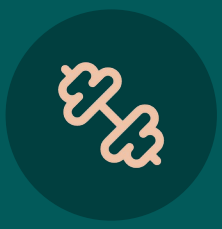
FUEL · MY NOTES

My notes: Fuel

Your page. Type on it in any PDF app, or print it and use a pen. Date every entry: in six weeks you will want to know what changed.

What I noticed after meals	What I am changing on my plate	When I test again

DATE _____



03

Exercise

Muscle is the organ that keeps paying you back.

YOUR ROUTE THROUGH EXERCISE

1 BRIEF
Exercise: muscle as a longevity organ

2 TOOL
The weekly planner, plus your week on paper

3 NOTES
My notes: Exercise

Exercise: Muscle as a Longevity Organ

Science-backed. Built for real life.

> *"If exercise could be packed into a pill, it would be the single most widely prescribed, and beneficial, medicine in the nation."*
> Robert Butler, MD

WHY IT MATTERS

Medicine, not calories

A 30-minute run burns about 300 calories. A muffin and a latte undo it. The real payoff: lower risk of type 2 diabetes, heart disease, dementia and some cancers.

Muscle fades quietly

After 30, you lose 3 to 8% of your muscle per decade unless you load it. That muscle is your metabolic engine and your blood sugar buffer.

Bones after menopause

When oestrogen drops, bone density falls fast. In the LIFTMOR trial, twice-weekly heavy lifting plus impact improved bone density in postmenopausal women with low bone mass.

Small dose, big return

About 75 minutes a week of moderate activity already lowers the risk of early death. Around 150 minutes captures most of the benefit. That is 1.5% of your week.

HOW IT WORKS

- **The sugar sponge**

  Working muscle pulls glucose out of your blood without needing insulin. Strength training improves insulin sensitivity, so your body needs less insulin to keep blood sugar steady.

- **The battery upgrade**

  Zone 2 charges the battery slowly so it holds more, building mitochondria (your cells' energy factories). HIIT drains it completely, raising VO_2 max, a strong predictor of lifespan.

- **Impact tells bone to build**

  Jumping and heavy lifting create impact forces that signal bone to remodel and strengthen. Multidirectional impact beats steady running, which is why jumps matter after menopause.

SELF-CHECK

Answer yes or no, right now.

Q1 Can you get up off the floor without using your hands?

Q2 Do you lift something heavy at least twice a week?

Q3 Do you average 7,000 steps a day across the week?

Q4 Do you do any balance or mobility work each week?

Every no is a lever. Add them one at a time.

THE 80/20: FOUR LEVERS, ADDED ONE AT A TIME

01 Walk the week

7,000 to 8,000 steps a day, or 50,000 a week when some days fall short. Every hour, stand up and move for 2 minutes.

Most of the benefit arrives before 8,000 steps.

02 Lift heavy, twice a week

30 minutes of compound lifts: squat, deadlift, press, row. Heavy enough that 6 reps is hard. Brace first, then add load over time.

Twice a week is the evidence-based minimum.

03 Cardio, then a little HIIT

150 minutes a week at a conversational pace. Once that sticks, add up to two HIIT sessions of 10 to 15 minutes.

HIIT is strong medicine: two a week, max.

04 Jump and balance

10 minutes of jumps (squat jumps, skipping, a rebounder) plus core and single-leg work, 2 to 3 times a week.

Exercise cuts falls by about 23%, balance work most.

THREE MISTAKES TO STOP MAKING

- × **Exercising to lose weight**

  You can't outrun a bad diet, and chasing the scale burns you out. Train for strength, endurance and energy. Body composition follows as a side effect.

- × **Cardio only**

  Running won't save you from sarcopenia (age-related muscle loss). Aerobic work won't hold on to muscle or bone. You need to lift.

- × **Overdoing HIIT**

  More than twice a week brings cortisol spikes, burnout and injury. Always sore, always tired, sleeping badly? Scale back.

This is educational, not personal medical advice. Your biology, history, and context matter. Work with a qualified healthcare professional.

EXERCISE · TOOL

The weekly planner

A plan in your head is a wish. A plan in your week is an appointment. **Put your sessions where they fit,** rest days included, and protect the slots like any other meeting.

Open the weekly planner →

On screen: Click the button.

On paper: Scan the code with your phone camera.

Or type it: tools.swissarmymum.com/planner

HOW IT WORKS

1
Open the planner
Click the button or scan the code. It works in your phone browser, nothing to install.

2
Fill in your week
Give each day a session and the minutes you can spare. Rest days count as sessions.

3
Add it to your calendar
Export your week as a calendar file and add it to your phone or computer calendar.

INSIDE THE PLANNER

Body
Strength, cardio, mobility and more. Any session that moves you counts.

Mind
Time for your head goes in the plan too, not only your muscles.

Rest
A planned day off. Recovery is where the progress happens.

Keep working on it
Upload a schedule you made before and pick up where you left off.

PREFER PAPER?

Turn the page. Every Body habit from the planner on one sheet, for four weeks. Print it once a month.

EXERCISE · PAPER PLANNER

Four weeks on paper

Print this page once a month. Tick a box on each day you do the habit. At the end of the week, count your ticks and write the total. **Aim for the target, not for perfect: 70% most weeks beats 100% once.**

WEEKS 1 AND 2

HABIT	TARGET	WEEK 1 · from ___ / ___								WEEK 2 · from ___ / ___							
		M	T	W	T	F	S	S	TOTAL	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	TOTAL
Example: Strength	*2× 30 min*	✓			✓				*2 / 2*		✓						*1 / 2*
Wind-down, fixed bedtime	5× 20 min								/ 5								/ 5
Daily walk (steps)	7× ~7,000								/ 7								/ 7
Strength training	2× 30 min								/ 2								/ 2
Zone 2 cardio	5× 30 min								/ 5								/ 5
HIIT	2× 15 min								/ 2								/ 2
Balance, mobility & jumps	3× 12 min								/ 3								/ 3

WEEKS 3 AND 4

HABIT	TARGET	WEEK 3 · from ___ / ___								WEEK 4 · from ___ / ___							
		M	T	W	T	F	S	S	TOTAL	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	TOTAL
Wind-down, fixed bedtime	5× 20 min								/ 5								/ 5
Daily walk (steps)	7× ~7,000								/ 7								/ 7
Strength training	2× 30 min								/ 2								/ 2
Zone 2 cardio	5× 30 min								/ 5								/ 5
HIIT	2× 15 min								/ 2								/ 2
Balance, mobility & jumps	3× 12 min								/ 3								/ 3

ABOUT ONCE A MONTH

- ☐ **Retake the sleep check**
- ☐ **Retake the metabolic check**

EXERCISE · MY NOTES

My notes: Exercise

Your page. Type on it in any PDF app, or print it and use a pen. Date every entry: in six weeks you will want to know what changed.

What felt easier this week

Where I added load

How I slept after training

DATE _____

EXERCISE · MORE NOTES

More notes: Exercise

Extra room. A second round, questions for your doctor, what worked and what did not.

DATE



04

Brain

Protect the command centre you will need for the next 50 years.

YOUR ROUTE THROUGH BRAIN

1 BRIEF
Brain Health: An Owner's Manual

2 NOTES
My notes: Brain

SWISS ARMY MUM

Not every tool. Just the right ones.

BODY · BRAIN

Brain Health: An Owner's Manual

Science-backed. Built for real life.

> *It's never too early or too late to take action.*
> Lancet Commission on Dementia Prevention, 2024

WHY IT MATTERS

Half is modifiable

In Canadian data, 12 modifiable factors accounted for 52% of dementia cases in women. Inactivity, hearing loss and high blood pressure led the list.

Midlife writes the bill

High blood pressure and diabetes in midlife still count decades later. Midlife diabetes raises dementia risk by roughly 60 to 70%.

A brain event

Oestradiol can fall by up to 90% across the transition. Changes in brain structure and energy use are specific to menopause, not just age.

Real, mostly temporary

More than 60% of women notice changes. A 26-study review confirms a measurable dip in verbal memory. For most women it fades after menopause.

HOW IT WORKS

Power and roads

Oestrogen helps run brain energy, from glucose uptake to mitochondrial power, and its loss reduces blood flow. Midlife high blood pressure damages the brain's wiring. Aerobic exercise boosts blood flow.

The night shift

In deep sleep, the glymphatic system flushes out waste, including Alzheimer's-linked proteins. In 40,000 adults, poor sleep plus inactivity showed the most wiring damage.

The construction crew

BDNF works like fertiliser for brain cells, and exercise raises it. Falling oestradiol lowers BDNF and raises inflammation, explaining about 38% of the oestrogen-memory link.

SELF-CHECK

Answer yes or no, right now.

Q1 Do you know your blood pressure from the last year?

Q2 Do you know your blood sugar from the last year?

Q3 Do you move about 150 minutes a week, and lift twice?

Q4 Do you sleep 7 to 9 hours on a consistent schedule?

Every no is a lever. Start with the easiest one.

THE 80/20: FOUR LEVERS THAT MOVE THE NEEDLE

01
Move, and lift things

About 150 minutes of moderate cardio a week, strength training twice a week, and 7,000 to 8,000 steps a day.

Strongest evidence tier. Raises BDNF and blood flow.

02
Know your numbers

Get your blood pressure and blood sugar checked, and act if they creep up. Book a hearing test while you're at it.

Silent risks you only catch by measuring.

03
Eat the pattern, not the superfood

Mediterranean-style: vegetables, legumes, olive oil, nuts, fish. Fewer ultra-processed foods.

Linked to less cognitive impairment across 32 studies.

04
Protect sleep, keep your people

Consistent schedule, morning light, cool room, caffeine cut-off. Modest alcohol, and time with people you enjoy.

Moderate evidence, and they help the other three work.

THREE MISTAKES TO STOP MAKING

× Hunting for a brain food

There is no single ingredient that sharpens you. The evidence supports the overall pattern of what you eat, held for years.

× Ignoring the boring numbers

Blood pressure, blood sugar and hearing don't feel like brain health. They are among the biggest midlife contributors to dementia risk.

× HRT as a memory pill

Treating hot flashes can protect your sleep. But guidelines do not support hormone therapy for cognition or dementia prevention.

This is educational, not personal medical advice. Your biology, history, and context matter. Work with a qualified healthcare professional.

BRAIN · MY NOTES

My notes: Brain

Your page. Type on it in any PDF app, or print it and use a pen. Date every entry: in six weeks you will want to know what changed.

The lever I am starting with	What I notice in my focus	When I check again

DATE _____

BRAIN · MORE NOTES

More notes: Brain

Extra room. A second round, questions for your doctor, what worked and what did not.

DATE

COMING IN LATER VERSIONS

This guide grows

Each new tool is released in a post first, then added here. Paid subscribers get the new version automatically.

SLEEP

Evening routine template and troubleshooting guide

EXERCISE

Strength primer: form guide and 12-week programme

FUEL

Calorie and meal planning prompt

BODY

Supplement scorecard

VERSION HISTORY

VERSION	DATE	WHAT CHANGED
1.0	25 Nov 2026	First release: six briefs, the sleep check, the metabolic health check, the metabolic markers tracker and the weekly planner.



Consistency beats perfection.

Not every tool. Just the right ones.

swissarmymum.com

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